

**MOUNT KENYA UNIVERSITY
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION**

**INFLUENCE OF TEACHER PREPAREDNESS ON THE
IMPLEMENTATION OF THE COMPETENCY-BASED CURRICULUM IN
PUBLIC PRIMARY SCHOOLS IN HABASWEIN SUB-COUNTY, WAJIR
COUNTY, KENYA**

MOHAMED ABDI IBRAHIM

A Research Proposal Submitted to the School of Education in Partial Fulfilment of the
Requirements for the Award of the Degree of Master of Education (Curriculum
Studies) of Mount Kenya University

SEPTEMBER 2026

DECLARATION

This research proposal is my original work and has not been presented for the award of a degree or for any other award in any other university.

Signature: _____ Date: _____

MOHAMED ABDI IBRAHIM

MED202432116

Supervisors' Approval

This research proposal has been submitted for examination with our approval as the university supervisors.

Signature: _____ Date: _____

School of Education, Mount Kenya University

Signature: _____ Date: _____

School of Education, Mount Kenya University

DEDICATION

To my family, who quietly took on extra load so that I could study, and to the teachers of Habaswein, who keep showing up for their learners even when conditions make it hard.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

First, I thank God for good health and for bringing me this far. I owe a lot to my supervisors, who read my drafts patiently and told me plainly where the argument was weak; the proposal is better because of them. My thanks also go to the lecturers and staff of the School of Education at Mount Kenya University, and to my classmates, with whom I shared many late nights and deadlines. A number of head teachers and teachers in Habaswein spoke to me informally about their work while I was still shaping this topic. Listening to them is what persuaded me that the study was worth doing. Lastly, I thank my family for their support throughout.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

DECLARATION.....	ii
DEDICATION.....	iii
ACKNOWLEDGEMENT.....	iv
LIST OF TABLES.....	vii
LIST OF FIGURES.....	viii
ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS.....	ix
OPERATIONAL DEFINITION OF TERMS.....	x
ABSTRACT.....	xii
CHAPTER ONE INTRODUCTION.....	1
1.1 Background to the Study.....	1
1.2 Statement of the Problem.....	3
1.3 Purpose of the Study.....	4
1.4 Research Objectives.....	4
1.5 Research Questions.....	4
1.6 Research Hypotheses.....	5
1.7 Justification of the Study.....	5
1.8 Significance of the Study.....	5
1.9 Limitations of the Study.....	6
1.10 Delimitations of the Study.....	6
1.11 Assumptions of the Study.....	6
CHAPTER TWO LITERATURE REVIEW.....	8
2.1 Introduction.....	8
2.2 Empirical Literature Review.....	8
2.2.1 In-service Training and Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum.....	8
2.2.2 Teachers' Attitude and Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum.....	9
2.2.3 Pedagogical Skills and Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum.....	9
2.2.4 Competency-Based Assessment Skills and Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum.....	10
2.3 Critique of Existing Literature.....	11
2.4 Summary of Literature and Research Gaps.....	11
2.5 Theoretical Framework.....	12
2.5.1 Concerns-Based Adoption Model.....	12
2.5.2 Theory of Pedagogical Content Knowledge.....	13
2.6 Conceptual Framework.....	13
CHAPTER THREE RESEARCH METHODOLOGY.....	16
3.1 Introduction.....	16

3.2 Research Methodology.....	16
3.3 Research Design.....	16
3.4 Location of the Study.....	17
3.5 Target Population.....	17
3.6 Sampling Techniques and Sample Size.....	17
3.6.1 Sampling Techniques.....	17
3.6.2 Sample Size.....	18
3.7 Research Instruments.....	19
3.8 Pilot Testing.....	20
3.8.1 Validity of Research Instruments.....	20
3.8.2 Reliability of Research Instruments.....	21
3.9 Data Collection Procedures.....	21
3.10 Data Analysis and Presentation.....	21
3.11 Ethical Considerations.....	23
REFERENCES.....	24
APPENDICES.....	28
Appendix I: Letter of Introduction.....	28
Appendix II: Informed Consent Form.....	28
Appendix III: Questionnaire for Teachers.....	29
Section A: Background Information.....	29
Section B: In-service Training on the CBC.....	29
Section C: Attitude towards the CBC.....	30
Section D: Pedagogical Skills.....	30
Section E: Competency-Based Assessment Skills.....	31
Section F: Implementation of the CBC.....	31
Section G: Intervening Factors.....	31
Section H: General Comments.....	32
Appendix IV: Interview Guide for Head Teachers.....	32
Appendix V: Classroom Observation Checklist.....	33
Appendix VI: Document Analysis Guide.....	34
Appendix VII: Work Plan.....	34
Appendix VIII: Research Budget.....	34

LIST OF TABLES

Table 2.1: Summary of Research Gaps.....	11
Table 3.1: Target Population.....	17
Table 3.2: Sample Size Distribution of Teachers.....	18
Table 3.3: Summary of Sample Size.....	18
Table 3.4: Operationalisation of Study Variables.....	19
Table 3.5: Summary of Data Analysis by Objective.....	22

LIST OF FIGURES

Figure 2.1: Conceptual Framework.....	14
---------------------------------------	----

ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

Abbreviation	Meaning
APHRC	African Population and Health Research Center
ASAL	Arid and Semi-Arid Lands
BOM	Board of Management
CBAM	Concerns-Based Adoption Model
CBC	Competency-Based Curriculum
CBE	Competency-Based Education
CSO	Curriculum Support Officer
CVI	Content Validity Index
ICT	Information and Communication Technology
JSS	Junior Secondary School
KICD	Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development
KNBS	Kenya National Bureau of Statistics
KPSEA	Kenya Primary School Education Assessment
MKU	Mount Kenya University
MoE	Ministry of Education
NACOSTI	National Commission for Science, Technology and Innovation
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
PCIs	Pertinent and Contemporary Issues
PCK	Pedagogical Content Knowledge
PWPER	Presidential Working Party on Education Reform
SPSS	Statistical Package for the Social Sciences
TALIS	Teaching and Learning International Survey
TSC	Teachers Service Commission
UNESCO	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

OPERATIONAL DEFINITION OF TERMS

Competency-Based Curriculum (CBC): The curriculum Kenya began rolling out in 2017 under the Basic Education Curriculum Framework, which emphasises what learners can do with what they learn rather than how much content they can recall. The Ministry of Education now calls it Competency-Based Education (CBE); in this proposal the two terms mean the same thing.

Teacher preparedness: The extent to which a teacher has been equipped, and is willing and able, to deliver the CBC as designed. In this study it is measured through four dimensions: in-service training, attitude towards the CBC, pedagogical skills and competency-based assessment skills.

In-service training: CBC training a teacher has received while in employment, measured by the number of trainings attended, their duration, the relevance of their content and the follow-up support provided.

Attitude towards the CBC: A teacher's feelings and beliefs about the CBC, measured by perceived usefulness of the curriculum, confidence in teaching it, willingness to adopt new practices and perception of the workload it brings.

Pedagogical skills: A teacher's ability to prepare schemes of work and lesson plans based on the curriculum designs, use learner-centred methods, integrate core competencies, values and PCIs, and improvise and use resources, including ICT.

Competency-based assessment skills: A teacher's ability to assess learners' competencies using varied formative tools such as rubrics, observation checklists, projects and portfolios, to keep assessment records and to give feedback to learners and parents.

Implementation of the CBC: The extent to which classroom practice matches what the curriculum designs expect, indicated by learner participation, timely coverage of the curriculum designs, completion of projects and community service learning, parental involvement and the proportion of learners meeting or exceeding expectations in school-based assessment.

Intervening variables: Conditions that may strengthen or weaken the influence of teacher preparedness on implementation, namely the availability of resources, class size, insecurity and teacher turnover, and government policy.

Public primary school: A government school in Habaswein Sub-County offering Grades 1 to 6 under the CBC, whose teachers are employed by the TSC or the Board of Management.

Marginalised area: An area that receives fewer services and records weaker education indicators than the national average, mainly because it is remote, arid, sparsely populated or insecure. Habaswein Sub-County is one such area.

ABSTRACT

Kenya replaced the 8-4-4 system with the Competency-Based Curriculum (CBC) so that learners would leave school able to think critically, solve problems and use what they have learnt. Whether this happens depends a great deal on how well teachers have been prepared for the new curriculum. Studies from several counties show that many teachers had only short cascade training, have mixed feelings about the reform, and find learner-centred teaching and competency-based assessment hard. These problems are probably worse in remote, arid and insecure areas, but most of the research so far comes from Nairobi, central and western Kenya. The purpose of this study is to establish the influence of teacher preparedness on the implementation of the CBC in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County, Wajir County. The objectives are to determine the influence of in-service training, assess the influence of teachers' attitude, establish the influence of pedagogical skills and examine the influence of competency-based assessment skills on CBC implementation. The study is anchored on the Concerns-Based Adoption Model and Shulman's theory of Pedagogical Content Knowledge. It will adopt a mixed methods approach within a descriptive survey design. The target population is 368 teachers and 46 head teachers in 46 public primary schools. A sample of 192 teachers will be selected using Yamane's formula and proportionate stratified random sampling, and 14 head teachers will be selected purposively. Data will be collected using a teacher questionnaire, a head teacher interview guide, a classroom observation checklist and a document analysis guide, all piloted in Wajir South Sub-County. Quantitative data will be analysed in SPSS using descriptive statistics, Pearson's correlation and simple and multiple linear regression, while qualitative data will be analysed thematically. It is hoped that the findings will help the Ministry of Education, the Teachers Service Commission, teacher training institutions and head teachers to prepare and support teachers in marginalised areas better.

Key words: teacher preparedness, in-service training, teacher attitude, pedagogical skills, competency-based assessment, curriculum implementation, Habaswein

CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background to the Study

Many countries have, over the last two decades, reformed their school curricula to focus on competencies, that is, what learners are able to do with the knowledge, skills and values they gain in school. The thinking behind this is simple. A lot of young people pass examinations and still find it hard to solve everyday problems, work in a team or carry on learning without a teacher. A competency-based curriculum tries to change this by changing the classroom itself. Learners are expected to do more of the work, and they are assessed as they learn rather than mostly at the end of a course. All of this rests on the teacher. Darling-Hammond (2017) compared teacher education in Finland, Singapore, Canada and Australia and found that the common factor in these strong systems was serious, long-term investment in preparing teachers, both before they start teaching and after. The Teaching and Learning International Survey (TALIS) reported something similar. Teachers whose initial training had covered content, pedagogy and practice in real classrooms said they felt better prepared, while many teachers across the participating countries still felt they needed more training in newer teaching methods and in handling learners with different needs (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development [OECD], 2019).

Getting teachers ready for a new curriculum takes more than a briefing. Hall and Hord (2020) found that teachers go through fairly predictable stages of concern when they are asked to adopt something new. At first they worry about what it means for them and how they will cope; only later do they start thinking about its effect on learners. If they are rushed, the change happens on paper and the old teaching carries on in class. Teacher shortages add to the difficulty. UNESCO and the International Task Force on Teachers for Education 2030 (2024) estimate that 44 million more teachers will be needed worldwide by 2030, about 15 million of them in sub-Saharan Africa, and note that many newly recruited teachers start work with little training. The regions attempting the biggest reforms are often the ones with the least prepared teachers.

African countries that have tried competency-based reforms have run into this problem. When South Africa launched outcomes-based education through Curriculum 2005, Jansen (1998) argued that the reform took for granted trained teachers and equipped classrooms that most schools simply did not have. The curriculum was revised more than once afterwards. Tanzania brought in a competence-based curriculum in 2005. Ten years later, Komba and Mwandangi (2015) found that many teachers were still not clear about competence-based teaching and had been given little training in it. Rwanda

changed to a competence-based curriculum in 2015, and Nsengimana et al. (2023) found that science teachers there still only partly understood what a competence is, with some still teaching in the old teacher-centred way. In Gulu City, Uganda, Kidega et al. (2024) reported that teachers with classes of around 66 learners, poor facilities and very little training often went back to lecturing. In each case the curriculum changed faster than the teachers could be prepared for it.

Kenya started its reform in 2017, when the Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development (KICD) introduced the Competency-Based Curriculum (CBC) under the Basic Education Curriculum Framework (KICD, 2017). Sessional Paper No. 1 of 2019 then gave the reform a policy basis (Ministry of Education [MoE], 2019). The CBC aims to build seven core competencies, among them communication and collaboration, critical thinking and problem solving, creativity and imagination, and digital literacy. The first CBC learners sat the Kenya Primary School Education Assessment (KPSEA) in 2022. In 2023 the Presidential Working Party on Education Reform (PWPER) recommended that the reform go on, but with fewer learning areas and with retooling for teachers who had trained under the old system (PWPER, 2023). The Ministry now uses the name Competency-Based Education (CBE). The demands on teachers are the same as before.

Those demands are heavy. A CBC teacher is expected to plan lessons around specific learning outcomes and key inquiry questions, bring values and pertinent and contemporary issues into lessons, use learner-centred methods, and assess learners through observation, projects, portfolios and other school-based tools (Mwang'ombe, 2021). Several Kenyan studies suggest that teachers were not well prepared for this. Akala (2021) describes the early rollout as rushed and short of resources. Momanyi and Rop (2019) found that early grade teachers in Bomet East had only a vague idea of what the CBC required of them. Karua et al. (2025) noted that teachers in Kinangop now knew more about CBC principles, but their teaching had not changed much. Most teachers were trained through short cascade workshops, and in Kilifi, Kailo and Njagi (2025) found that the quality of training resources had a significant effect on how well teachers implemented the curriculum. Cheruiyot (2024) reported that many teachers were still unsure how to do competency-based assessment. In Bomet, Keter and Wabuke (2025) found a positive relationship between teacher preparedness and CBC implementation. An evaluation by the African Population and Health Research Center (APHRC, 2022) also found that properly learner-centred lessons were still uncommon.

If teachers in fairly well-served counties are struggling, there is good reason to worry about the arid north-east. Wajir County falls within Kenya's Arid and Semi-Arid Lands, where long distances, frequent droughts and the movement of pastoralist families have kept education indicators below the national average for a long time. Habaswein Sub-

County lies in the south-west of the county and had about 174,000 people at the 2019 census (Kenya National Bureau of Statistics [KNBS], 2019). Its schools serve settled families as well as pastoralists living in scattered settlements. Since 2023, insecurity linked to al-Shabaab has pushed many non-local teachers to ask for transfers out of Wajir, Mandera and Garissa, and the Teachers Service Commission (TSC) has hired contract teachers to fill the vacancies (“How TSC Beat Teachers Crisis,” 2024). Many of these teachers are newly qualified and have had little or no CBC training. Hussein (2023) observed that in northern Kenya, CBC implementation was held back by weak training, few resources and difficulty with the new teaching methods. Even so, there is very little local data on how prepared Habaswein teachers are for the CBC, or on how their preparedness shapes what happens in the classroom.

1.2 Statement of the Problem

Ideally, every public primary school in Kenya should by now have teachers who have been trained in the CBC, who support it, who can plan and teach learner-centred lessons, and who assess learners continuously. Learners taught by such teachers would complete Grade 6 with the competencies the curriculum promises. This is what the Basic Education Curriculum Framework (KICD, 2017) and the PWPER (2023) report expect. The reality, nearly ten years after the rollout began, is different. Studies in several counties have found that many teachers had only short cascade training, are still unsure of what the CBC requires, find competency-based assessment confusing and keep teaching in a teacher-centred way (Cheruiyot, 2024; Kailo & Njagi, 2025; Karua et al., 2025; Mutua & Waweru, 2023).

In Habaswein Sub-County the situation is probably worse. Schools are remote, instructional materials are scarce, workloads are heavy and teachers rarely get chances for professional development. When many non-local teachers left in 2023, some schools were left relying on newly recruited or contract teachers, some of whom may never have attended any CBC training (“How TSC Beat Teachers Crisis,” 2024). Poorly prepared teachers mean that learners miss the practical, skills-based learning the CBC was meant to deliver, and the gap between marginalised regions and the rest of the country could widen. Most research on teacher preparedness and the CBC, however, has been done in Nairobi, Machakos, Bomet, Nyandarua, Kilifi and western Kenya. We know little about how well Habaswein teachers have been prepared in terms of training, attitude, pedagogical skills and assessment skills, or about how each of these affects CBC implementation (APHRC, 2022; Hussein, 2023). Without this information, support for teachers in the sub-county is likely to stay general and poorly targeted. This study therefore seeks to establish the influence of teacher preparedness on the implementation of the CBC in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.

1.3 Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this study is to establish the influence of teacher preparedness on the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County, Wajir County, Kenya.

1.4 Research Objectives

The study will be guided by the following objectives:

- (i) To determine the influence of teachers' in-service training on the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.
- (ii) To assess the influence of teachers' attitude towards the Competency-Based Curriculum on its implementation in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.
- (iii) To establish the influence of teachers' pedagogical skills on the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.
- (iv) To examine the influence of teachers' competency-based assessment skills on the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.

1.5 Research Questions

The study will seek to answer the following questions:

- (i) How does teachers' in-service training influence the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County?
- (ii) What is the influence of teachers' attitude towards the Competency-Based Curriculum on its implementation in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County?
- (iii) How do teachers' pedagogical skills influence the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County?
- (iv) What is the influence of teachers' competency-based assessment skills on the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County?

1.6 Research Hypotheses

The following null hypotheses will be tested at the 0.05 level of significance:

H₀₁: Teachers' in-service training has no statistically significant influence on the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.

H₀₂: Teachers' attitude towards the Competency-Based Curriculum has no statistically significant influence on its implementation in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.

H₀₃: Teachers' pedagogical skills have no statistically significant influence on the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.

H₀₄: Teachers' competency-based assessment skills have no statistically significant influence on the implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County.

1.7 Justification of the Study

This study is timely for three reasons. To begin with, the first CBC learners are already in junior school and the PWPER (2023) has called for teachers to be retooled. Retooling can only be planned well if we know which parts of teacher preparedness are weakest and which have the most effect on implementation, especially in areas that national studies usually leave out. Secondly, the north-east has gone through an unusual staffing upheaval since 2023. Experienced non-local teachers left and new or contract teachers took their places ("How TSC Beat Teachers Crisis," 2024), and this has probably changed how prepared the teaching force is in ways earlier studies could not have picked up. Thirdly, the little research done in northern Kenya (Hussein, 2023) is small in scale and mostly descriptive. No study has tested statistically how the different dimensions of teacher preparedness influence implementation in Habaswein. This study will help fill that gap and give policy makers something more specific to work with than broad statements about "challenges in marginalised areas".

1.8 Significance of the Study

The findings should be of use to the following groups:

- The Ministry of Education and the TSC, when designing retooling and in-service programmes for teachers in arid and remote areas and when planning staffing and hardship incentives.

- The Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development, when revising training content and support materials so that they work in low-resource schools.
- Teacher training institutions, which may use them to improve pre-service and in-service courses, particularly on learner-centred teaching and competency-based assessment.
- Head teachers and Boards of Management, when planning school-based professional development, peer support and instructional supervision.
- Teachers themselves, who will get a clearer picture of how prepared they are and what kind of support actually helps.
- Researchers, who will have data from a region that is rarely studied and a starting point for further work on curriculum reform in marginalised areas.

1.9 Limitations of the Study

Some teachers may not want to admit weaknesses in their preparation in case the information is used against them. To reduce this, the questionnaire will not ask for names, respondents will be told that the study has no link to TSC appraisal, and teachers' answers will be compared with what is seen in classroom observation and school records. Getting to remote schools may be hard because the sub-county is large, roads are poor and some places are insecure. The researcher will plan travel with the Sub-County Director of Education and the local administration and will visit during the dry season. On some days, pastoralist movement may reduce the number of learners in class. If a class is too small to show normal teaching, the observation will be moved to another day.

1.10 Delimitations of the Study

The study is limited to public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County, Wajir County. Private schools, pre-primary centres and junior schools are left out because they are staffed and run differently. The respondents will be teachers of Grades 1 to 6 and head teachers. Teacher preparedness will be looked at under four dimensions only: in-service training, attitude towards the CBC, pedagogical skills and competency-based assessment skills. Implementation will be measured using classroom-level indicators. Data will be collected in March and April 2027.

1.11 Assumptions of the Study

The study assumes that respondents will answer truthfully, that the records at the Sub-County Director of Education's office give a correct count of schools and teachers, that

the sampled schools will be safe to visit during data collection, and that the lessons observed will be typical of how the teachers normally teach.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

This chapter looks at what other researchers have found on teacher preparedness and the implementation of competency-based curricula. The empirical studies are reviewed first, under the four objectives of the study. A critique of the literature and a summary of the research gaps come next, followed by the theoretical framework. The chapter closes with the conceptual framework, which shows how the variables are expected to relate.

2.2 Empirical Literature Review

2.2.1 In-service Training and Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum

Most studies on teacher preparedness start with training. Darling-Hammond et al. (2017) reviewed 35 studies of professional development and found that the training which changed classroom practice was usually sustained over time, tied to subject content, active and backed by coaching. One-off workshops rarely had much effect. Guskey (2002) points out that teachers tend to change their beliefs only after they have tried a new practice and seen it work with their own learners. Follow-up support after training is therefore important. TALIS data show that most teachers in OECD countries take part in some professional development, and that the training they find most useful is practical and involves working with colleagues (OECD, 2019).

African studies often blame weak implementation on poor training. Komba and Mwandangi (2015) found that many Tanzanian secondary school teachers had not been trained for the competence-based curriculum and were unsure how to plan and teach competence-based lessons. Kidega et al. (2024) found much the same in Gulu City, Uganda. Teachers there who had received little training on the new curriculum often went back to lecturing.

In Kenya, most teachers first met the CBC through short cascade workshops, where a few teachers were trained and then expected to train the others. Kailo and Njagi (2025) looked at in-service training in public primary schools in Kilifi County. They found that the quality of training resources and materials had a significant influence on CBC implementation, and many of the teachers they spoke to felt the cascade model was not enough. In Nairobi County, Mogere (2022) found that teacher preparedness, training included, was one of the strongest determinants of CBC implementation. Hussein (2023), one of the few researchers to work in northern Kenya, reported that teachers

with little training struggled with the new learning areas, teaching strategies and assessment methods.

The studies agree that training matters. Most of them, however, only record whether a teacher was trained. They say little about how much training the teacher got, how relevant it was or whether anyone followed up afterwards. None was done in an area like Habaswein, where many teachers arrived after 2023 and so missed the main rounds of CBC training. This study will measure these aspects of training and test how they affect implementation.

2.2.2 Teachers' Attitude and Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum

Training alone does not guarantee that a teacher will put a reform into practice. If the teacher does not believe in it, implementation is likely to be half-hearted. Fullan (2016) argues that change in schools depends on teachers finding personal meaning in it. Where they do not, they go along with it on the surface and keep their old habits. Hall and Hord's (2020) Stages of Concern say something similar. A teacher's first concerns about an innovation are personal and practical, such as workload, time and whether they can manage it, and attitudes tend to improve once these concerns are dealt with. TALIS data also link teachers' self-efficacy, or confidence in their own teaching, to the support they receive and to their readiness to try new methods (OECD, 2019).

Kenyan teachers' attitudes towards the CBC appear to be mixed. Akala (2021) notes that teachers' unions and parents complained about how fast the curriculum was rolled out and about the extra work it brought. Many teachers seem to have met the reform with some anxiety. Murithi and Yoo (2021) surveyed 351 primary school teachers and found that most were positive about using ICT in the CBC. Poor facilities and weak technical skills, though, meant that this positive attitude often did not show in their teaching. In Machakos County, Mutua and Waweru (2023) treated attitude as one part of teacher competence, together with knowledge and skills, and found that competence was associated with the level of CBC implementation.

In most of these studies attitude is combined with other measures, so its own effect on implementation is seldom tested. Attitude is also likely to depend on local conditions. Insecurity, isolation and heavy workloads are common in Habaswein but did not feature in the areas studied so far. This study will measure teachers' attitude towards the CBC as a separate dimension of preparedness.

2.2.3 Pedagogical Skills and Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum

Pedagogical skills are where training and attitude are tested in the classroom. Nsengimana et al. (2023) interviewed Rwandan science teachers eight years after the

competence-based curriculum was introduced. The teachers could explain the aims of the reform, yet several still taught in a teacher-centred way. In Uganda, Kidega et al. (2024) found that large classes and limited training pushed teachers back to lecturing, even though they knew learner-centred methods were expected.

APHRC (2022) observed CBC lessons in several Kenyan counties and found big differences between teachers. Some lessons were lively and learner-centred. Many others still relied on chalk-and-talk and the whole class repeating after the teacher. The better lessons were not mainly the ones with more resources. They were the ones where the teacher planned good activities, asked open questions and got learners involved. Awiti (2023) found that teachers' skill in learner-centred approaches had a strong effect on CBC implementation in public primary schools in Nairobi City. Mwang'ombe (2021) noticed that many teachers could name the core competencies but could not say how they would develop them in a lesson. In Kinangop, Karua et al. (2025) found that teachers picked up CBC terms faster than they changed the way they taught. Murithi and Yoo (2021) also reported that teachers seldom used ICT in their lessons, mostly because of weak skills and poor facilities.

From these studies, pedagogical skill seems to be the area where teachers need the most help. Most of the studies, though, used questionnaires only, and few checked what teachers said against what they actually did in class. None was done in the arid north-east. This study will use questionnaires, lesson observation and a review of lesson plans and schemes of work to measure the pedagogical skills of teachers in Habaswein.

2.2.4 Competency-Based Assessment Skills and Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum

In a competency-based curriculum, learners are judged on what they can do as well as on what they remember, so assessment carries a lot of weight. Black and Wiliam (1998), in a widely cited review, showed that formative assessment raises achievement considerably when it is done well. This means that teachers collect evidence of learning during lessons and use it to adjust their teaching and give feedback. Competency-based assessment needs these same skills, plus the ability to use rubrics, observation checklists, projects and portfolios.

Studies in Africa suggest that teachers are least prepared in this area. Komba and Mwandangi (2015) found that Tanzanian teachers kept using traditional tests because nobody had shown them how to assess competencies. In Kenya, Cheruiyot (2024) found that many junior school teachers were unsure how to carry out formative and school-based assessment. They kept learner portfolios because they had to, and the portfolios did little to guide their teaching. Awiti (2023) reported that in Nairobi, large

classes made it very hard to assess learners one by one. Mwang'ombe (2021) noted that many teachers were frustrated by the amount of record-keeping the CBC requires.

These studies show that assessment is a problem. Few of them, however, measured teachers' assessment skills directly or tested how much those skills affect implementation. Habaswein has an extra difficulty. Pastoralist families move often, and continuous assessment is hard when learners do not attend regularly. This study will examine how teachers' assessment skills influence CBC implementation in this setting.

2.3 Critique of Existing Literature

The studies reviewed agree that teacher preparedness affects implementation, but they have four weaknesses. The first concerns location. Most of the Kenyan studies were done in Nairobi, Machakos, Bomet, Nyandarua, Kilifi and other counties where training and supervision are fairly easy to reach. The north-east appears mostly in small descriptive studies such as Hussein (2023). Secondly, many studies relied on what teachers said about themselves, and teachers tend to overrate their own preparedness. Only a few (APHRC, 2022; Keter & Wabuke, 2025) also observed lessons. Thirdly, several studies measured preparedness as one variable. It is then impossible to tell whether training, attitude, pedagogical skills or assessment skills matter most. Finally, most of the studies came before the staffing crisis in the north-east in 2023 and the policy changes that followed the PWPER report. This study tries to deal with these weaknesses. It focuses on Habaswein, measures four separate dimensions of preparedness, checks what teachers say against observation and school records, and treats insecurity and teacher turnover as intervening variables.

2.4 Summary of Literature and Research Gaps

Overall, the review shows that many teachers working with competency-based curricula had little training, have mixed feelings about the reform and are not confident with learner-centred teaching or competency-based assessment. Implementation is generally better where teachers are better prepared. Table 2.1 sums up the main studies and the gaps they leave.

Table 2.1: Summary of Research Gaps

Author(s) and Year	Focus of Study	Key Findings	Research Gap
Komba and Mwandangi (2015)	Implementation of competence-based curriculum, Tanzania	Teachers not trained to plan, teach or assess competencies	Different country and level; preparedness not measured by dimension
Momanyi and Rop (2019)	Teacher preparedness for CBC, Bomet East	Teachers' grasp of CBC was vague and hindered implementation	Early grades only; high-potential area

Author(s) and Year	Focus of Study	Key Findings	Research Gap
Murithi and Yoo (2021)	Teachers' use of ICT in CBC	Positive attitudes but low use due to poor facilities and skills	ICT only; not region-specific
Mutua and Waweru (2023)	Teacher competence and CBC implementation, Machakos	Competence associated with implementation	Setting differs from arid, insecure north-east
Hussein (2023)	Challenges of CBC in northern Kenya	Weak training, few resources, difficulty with new methods	Small sample; descriptive; influence not tested
Cheruiyot (2024)	Challenges of CBC in junior schools	Teachers unsure of formative and school-based assessment	Qualitative; junior schools; not region-specific
Karua et al. (2025)	Teacher preparedness, Kinangop	Awareness improved but pedagogy not aligned to CBC	Relatively well-resourced area
Keter and Wabuke (2025)	Preparedness and CBC implementation, Bomet JSS	Positive relationship between preparedness and implementation	Junior schools; not a marginalised setting
Kailo and Njagi (2025)	In-service training and CBC, Kilifi	Training materials significantly influenced implementation	Training only; other dimensions not examined

Source: Researcher (2026)

What is missing is a study that measures the separate dimensions of teacher preparedness in a marginalised and insecure area and tests how each one affects CBC implementation. This study in Habaswein Sub-County has been designed to do that.

2.5 Theoretical Framework

Two theories guide this study: the Concerns-Based Adoption Model and Shulman's theory of Pedagogical Content Knowledge.

2.5.1 Concerns-Based Adoption Model

The Concerns-Based Adoption Model (CBAM) was developed at the University of Texas in the 1970s. Hall and Hord (2020) give a full account of it. The model starts from the idea that change is a process that takes time, and that individual people have to change before an institution can. It has three parts. The Stages of Concern describe how a teacher's feelings about an innovation develop. At first the teacher just wants information. Personal concerns follow ("What does this mean for me?"), then management concerns ("Where will I find the time and materials?"), and only later concern for learners and for working with colleagues to make it better. The Levels of Use describe what teachers actually do with the innovation, from not using it at all, to

using it mechanically, to using it routinely and refining it. Innovation Configurations describe the different shapes an innovation takes once it gets into real classrooms.

CBAM fits this study because the CBC is an innovation that Habaswein teachers have taken up to different degrees. It relates most closely to the first two objectives. It helps explain why in-service training (Objective 1) matters, since training and follow-up support are what move teachers past their early, self-focused worries towards confident use. The Stages of Concern also deal with how teachers feel about the CBC, which this study measures as attitude (Objective 2). A teacher who is still anxious about workload or about coping is likely to remain at the mechanical level of use. The Levels of Use are useful for thinking about the dependent variable as well, because good implementation is close to what the model calls routine or refined use. One weakness of CBAM is that it looks mainly at the individual teacher and says less about wider conditions such as resources, policy changes and insecurity (Hall & Hord, 2020). In this study those conditions are treated as intervening variables.

2.5.2 Theory of Pedagogical Content Knowledge

Shulman (1986) argued that knowing a subject well is not enough to teach it well, and neither is knowing general teaching methods. Good teaching needs a mix of the two, which he called pedagogical content knowledge (PCK). PCK is knowing how to present a particular topic so that a particular group of learners will understand it. It includes knowing which examples and activities work and where learners usually get confused. It also covers knowing how to find out what learners have understood, which is what good assessment depends on.

This theory relates to Objectives 3 and 4. The CBC changes how learning areas are taught and assessed as well as what is taught. A teacher may know a learning area very well and still not know how to turn it into an inquiry activity, a project or a realistic assessment task. In Shulman's terms, pedagogical skills (Objective 3) and competency-based assessment skills (Objective 4) are the ways a teacher's PCK shows in a CBC classroom. The better these skills, the closer a lesson is likely to come to what the curriculum designers had in mind. The theory's weakness is that PCK is hard to see directly, and teachers usually rate their own skills too highly. The study will therefore not rely on questionnaires alone but will also observe lessons and look at lesson plans and assessment records.

2.6 Conceptual Framework

Figure 2.1 shows the expected relationship between the variables. Teacher preparedness is the independent variable. It is measured through four dimensions: in-service training on the CBC, teachers' attitude towards the CBC, pedagogical skills and competency-

based assessment skills. The dependent variable is implementation of the CBC. Some intervening variables may also affect the relationship. The study will not control them but will take them into account.

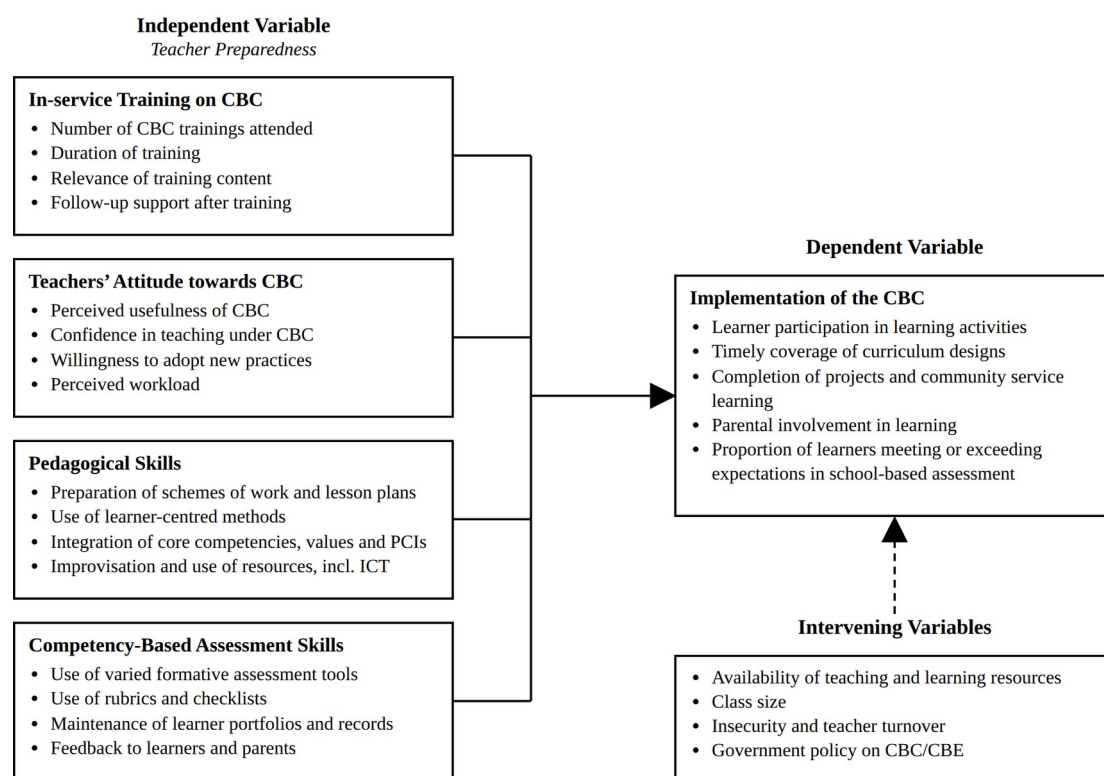


Figure 2.1: Conceptual Framework

Source: Researcher (2026)

In-service training will be measured by how many CBC trainings a teacher has attended, how long they lasted, how relevant the content was and whether there was any follow-up support. Teachers with more training, longer training and more relevant training, followed up afterwards, are expected to implement the CBC better.

Teachers' attitude will be measured by how useful teachers think the CBC is, how confident they feel teaching it, how willing they are to try new practices and how they see the workload it brings. Teachers with a more positive attitude are expected to implement the curriculum more fully.

Pedagogical skills will be measured by how teachers prepare schemes of work and lesson plans from the curriculum designs, how far they use learner-centred methods, whether they bring core competencies, values and pertinent and contemporary issues (PCIs) into lessons, and how they improvise and use resources, ICT included.

Competency-based assessment skills will be measured by teachers' use of different formative assessment tools, their use of rubrics and checklists, how they keep learner portfolios and assessment records, and the feedback they give to learners and parents.

Implementation of the CBC, the dependent variable, will be measured by learner participation in learning activities, whether the curriculum designs are covered on time, whether projects and community service learning activities are completed, how involved parents are, and the proportion of learners who meet or exceed expectations in school-based assessment.

Intervening variables are the availability of teaching and learning resources, class size, insecurity and teacher turnover, and government policy on the CBC. Any of these may strengthen or weaken the effect of preparedness on implementation. Information on them will be collected through the questionnaire and interviews and taken into account when the findings are interpreted.

CHAPTER THREE

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter sets out how the study will be done. It covers the research methodology and design, where the study will take place, the target population, how the sample will be chosen and how big it will be, the instruments, pilot testing, validity and reliability, how data will be collected and analysed, and ethical issues.

3.2 Research Methodology

Research methodology is the general strategy and philosophy behind a study. Research design is the more specific plan for collecting and analysing data within that strategy (Kothari & Garg, 2019; Saunders et al., 2019). This study takes a pragmatist position. Pragmatists hold that the research question should decide which methods are used, and that combining numbers with people's own accounts can give a fuller answer than either would alone (Creswell & Creswell, 2023).

Following from this, the study will use a mixed methods approach. On the quantitative side, a structured questionnaire will measure the four dimensions of teacher preparedness and the level of CBC implementation, and the four null hypotheses will be tested statistically. On the qualitative side, interviews with head teachers, classroom observation and document analysis will help explain why teachers are prepared the way they are and what this looks like in class. Using both also means that what teachers say about themselves can be checked against what they do, which was one of the main weaknesses noted in the literature.

3.3 Research Design

A descriptive survey design will be used, following a convergent parallel mixed methods approach. A descriptive survey gathers data from a fairly large group of respondents at one point in time and describes things as they are, without manipulating any variable (Creswell & Creswell, 2023). This suits a study that wants to find out how prepared teachers are now and how that relates to CBC implementation. In a convergent parallel approach, the quantitative and qualitative data are collected at the same time, analysed separately and then compared when the results are interpreted (Creswell & Creswell, 2023). Mugenda and Mugenda (2003) note that the design is common in Kenyan education research because it gives both a broad picture and a closer look at practice.

3.4 Location of the Study

The study will take place in Habaswein Sub-County, Wajir County, in north-eastern Kenya. The sub-county is in the south-west of the county on the Garissa–Wajir road, and Habaswein town is its headquarters. It had about 174,000 residents at the 2019 census (KNBS, 2019). The area is hot and dry. Most households keep livestock, though more families are now settling around trading centres. Some schools in Habaswein town are fairly large, while others are small and remote and serve pastoralist communities.

There were three reasons for choosing Habaswein. It is a good example of the marginalised areas that CBC research seldom covers. It was hit directly when non-local teachers left after 2023 (“How TSC Beat Teachers Crisis,” 2024), so the question of how prepared its teachers are is pressing. And the researcher knows the area and its schools well, which will make access easier and help with making sense of the findings.

3.5 Target Population

The target population is all teachers and head teachers in public primary schools in Habaswein Sub-County. Current working figures are about 46 public primary schools, with around 368 teachers and 46 head teachers. The researcher will confirm these numbers with the Office of the Sub-County Director of Education before sampling. The schools are put into three strata based on the main types of setting in the sub-county (Table 3.1).

Table 3.1: Target Population

Stratum	Number of Schools	Number of Teachers	Number of Head Teachers
Habaswein town and environs	10	124	10
Rural settled schools	20	164	20
Remote / pastoralist schools	16	80	16
Total	46	368	46

Source: Office of the Sub-County Director of Education, Habaswein (2026)

3.6 Sampling Techniques and Sample Size

3.6.1 Sampling Techniques

Teachers will be chosen by proportionate stratified random sampling. Stratifying makes sure that teachers in town, rural and remote schools are included in proportion to their numbers. This matters because conditions in the three settings are very different. In each stratum the teachers will be listed school by school, and a table of random numbers will be used to pick them. Head teachers will be chosen by stratified purposive sampling. In each stratum the researcher will pick head teachers from schools of different sizes and

staffing levels so that the interviews cover a range of experiences. Lesson observation and document analysis will be done in these same 14 schools.

3.6.2 Sample Size

Yamane's (1967) formula was used to calculate the teacher sample, at a 95% confidence level and a 5% margin of error:

$$n = N / (1 + N(e)^2)$$

where n is the sample size, N is the target population of teachers (368) and e is the margin of error (0.05). Substituting these values gives:

$$n = 368 / (1 + 368 \times 0.0025) = 368 / 1.92 = 191.7 \approx 192 \text{ teachers}$$

The 192 teachers will be shared among the three strata in proportion to their size (Table 3.2). Fourteen head teachers will be selected. This is about 30% of the 46, which is within the 10% to 30% that Mugenda and Mugenda (2003) consider enough for a descriptive study.

Table 3.2: Sample Size Distribution of Teachers

Stratum	Number of Teachers	Proportion	Sample Size
Habaswein town and environs	124	0.337	65
Rural settled schools	164	0.446	86
Remote / pastoralist schools	80	0.217	41
Total	368	1.000	192

Source: Researcher (2026)

Table 3.3: Summary of Sample Size

Category	Target Population	Sample Size	Sampling Technique
Teachers	368	192	Proportionate stratified random
Head teachers	46	14	Stratified purposive
Total	414	206	

Source: Researcher (2026)

The researcher will also observe 28 lessons, two in each of the 14 schools, and review the schemes of work, lesson plans, learner portfolios and assessment records in those schools.

3.7 Research Instruments

Four instruments will be used, so that what comes from one source can be checked against the others.

Teacher questionnaire. The 192 sampled teachers will fill in a structured questionnaire (Appendix III). It has eight sections: background information, in-service training, attitude towards the CBC, pedagogical skills, competency-based assessment skills, implementation of the CBC, intervening factors, and a last open question for suggestions. Apart from the background and open sections, items use a five-point Likert scale from 1 (strongly disagree) to 5 (strongly agree). The questionnaire is in English, which teachers use at work, and takes about 25 minutes.

Interview guide for head teachers. The 14 head teachers will be interviewed using a semi-structured guide (Appendix IV). The questions ask how teachers were trained for the CBC, how they feel about it, how they teach and assess, what support the school gives, and how well the head teacher thinks the CBC is being implemented. Each interview should take 30 to 45 minutes.

Classroom observation checklist. The researcher will use a checklist (Appendix V), based on the CBC lesson structure, to observe 28 lessons. It looks for evidence of lesson planning, learner-centred methods, core competencies, values and PCIs, use of resources, assessment and learner participation. Each item is marked as not observed, partly observed or fully observed.

Document analysis guide. The researcher will go through schemes of work, lesson plans, learner portfolios, assessment records and training records (Appendix VI) to check what teachers report and what is seen in class.

Table 3.4 shows how each variable will be measured.

Table 3.4: Operationalisation of Study Variables

Variable	Type	Indicators	Measurement Scale	Tool
In-service training on CBC	Independent	Number of trainings attended; duration; relevance of content; follow-up support	Ordinal; five-point Likert	Questionnaire (Section B); interview; training records
Teachers' attitude towards CBC	Independent	Perceived usefulness; confidence; willingness to adopt new practices; perceived workload	Five-point Likert	Questionnaire (Section C); interview

Variable	Type	Indicators	Measurement Scale	Tool
Pedagogical skills	Independent	Schemes of work and lesson plans; learner-centred methods; integration of competencies, values and PCIs; use of resources and ICT	Five-point Likert; three-point observation scale	Questionnaire (Section D); observation; documents
Competency-based assessment skills	Independent	Varied formative assessment tools; rubrics and checklists; portfolios and records; feedback	Five-point Likert; three-point observation scale	Questionnaire (Section E); observation; documents
Implementation of CBC	Dependent	Learner participation; curriculum coverage; projects and community service learning; parental involvement; learners meeting expectations	Five-point Likert; three-point observation scale	Questionnaire (Section F); observation; documents
Intervening factors	Intervening	Resources; class size; insecurity and turnover; government policy	Five-point Likert; themes	Questionnaire (Section G); interview

Source: Researcher (2026)

3.8 Pilot Testing

The instruments will be piloted in public primary schools in Wajir South Sub-County. It borders Habaswein and has similar conditions, but it is not part of the main sample. Following Mugenda and Mugenda (2003), the pilot will involve 19 teachers (about 10% of the teacher sample) and two head teachers, plus two lesson observations. The pilot will show which items are unclear, how long the questionnaire takes, whether the observation checklist is practical, and how reliable the scales are. The instruments will then be revised.

3.8.1 Validity of Research Instruments

Validity is how far an instrument measures what it is supposed to measure (Creswell & Creswell, 2023). For content validity, each item will be matched to an objective and to the indicators in Table 3.4. The university supervisors and two experts in curriculum studies will then rate how relevant each item is. A Content Validity Index (CVI) will be worked out from their ratings, and 0.80 or above will be accepted. The pilot will also check face validity, that is, whether teachers understand the items the way they are meant.

3.8.2 Reliability of Research Instruments

Reliability is how consistently an instrument gives the same results under similar conditions (Creswell & Creswell, 2023). Cronbach's alpha will be calculated for each Likert scale from the pilot data. A value of 0.70 or more will be accepted, and any item that pulls a scale below this will be reworded or dropped. For the observation checklist, the researcher and a trained research assistant will each rate the two pilot lessons on their own and then compare scores. For the qualitative data, trustworthiness will come from triangulation, detailed field notes, audio recordings of interviews (where the respondent agrees) and a written record of analysis decisions (Braun & Clarke, 2022).

3.9 Data Collection Procedures

Once the proposal is approved, the researcher will get an introduction letter from Mount Kenya University, ethical clearance from the university's ethics review committee, and a research permit from the National Commission for Science, Technology and Innovation (NACOSTI). The researcher will then ask for permission from the Wajir County Director of Education, the TSC Sub-County Director, the Sub-County Director of Education in Habaswein and the local administration. Head teachers of the sampled schools will be contacted to agree on dates for the visits.

Three research assistants who know the area will be hired and given two days of training on the instruments, the sampling procedure and research ethics. Questionnaires will be taken to schools in person and, where possible, picked up the same day so that more are returned. The researcher will carry out all the head teacher interviews and lesson observations, and a research assistant will sit in on some lessons to check that ratings are consistent. Documents will be reviewed on the same visits. Data collection will run through March and April 2027, and visits to remote schools will be planned with advice from local security officers.

3.10 Data Analysis and Presentation

Completed questionnaires will be checked for completeness, coded and entered into the Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS) version 29. Frequencies, percentages, means and standard deviations will be used to describe each dimension of preparedness and the level of implementation. On the five-point scale, a mean of 4.0 or more will be read as high, 3.0 to 3.9 as moderate and below 3.0 as low.

For each null hypothesis, Pearson's product-moment correlation will first show how strong the relationship is between that dimension of preparedness and implementation, and in which direction. Simple linear regression will then be used to estimate its influence:

$$Y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X_i + \varepsilon$$

Here Y is implementation of the CBC, β_0 is the constant, β_1 is the regression coefficient, X_i is the composite score for the dimension being tested ($i = 1, 2, 3, 4$) and ε is the error term. A multiple regression model will then show the combined influence of the four dimensions and how much each one contributes:

$$Y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X_1 + \beta_2 X_2 + \beta_3 X_3 + \beta_4 X_4 + \varepsilon$$

In this model, X_1 is in-service training, X_2 is attitude towards the CBC, X_3 is pedagogical skills and X_4 is competency-based assessment skills. Before running the regressions, the researcher will check the assumptions of normality, linearity, homoscedasticity and no multicollinearity. A null hypothesis will be rejected if $p < 0.05$.

Interview recordings, observation notes and document reviews will be transcribed and analysed thematically, following the six phases described by Braun and Clarke (2022). These are getting familiar with the data, coding, generating themes, reviewing them, defining and naming them, and writing up. Ratings from the observation checklist will be summarised as frequencies and percentages. Quantitative results will be shown in tables and charts, and qualitative results as themes with short quotations from respondents. The two sets of results will then be compared and discussed side by side. The analysis plan is summarised in Table 3.5.

Table 3.5: Summary of Data Analysis by Objective

Objective	Data Source	Method of Analysis
1. In-service training and implementation of CBC	Questionnaire; interviews; training records	Descriptive statistics; Pearson's correlation; simple linear regression (H_{01}); thematic analysis
2. Attitude towards CBC and implementation	Questionnaire; interviews	Descriptive statistics; Pearson's correlation; simple linear regression (H_{02}); thematic analysis
3. Pedagogical skills and implementation of CBC	Questionnaire; observation; documents	Descriptive statistics; Pearson's correlation; simple linear regression (H_{03}); thematic analysis
4. Competency-based assessment skills and implementation of CBC	Questionnaire; observation; documents	Descriptive statistics; Pearson's correlation; simple linear regression (H_{04}); thematic analysis

Objective	Data Source	Method of Analysis
Combined influence of the four dimensions	Questionnaire	Multiple linear regression

Source: Researcher (2026)

3.11 Ethical Considerations

No data will be collected until the Mount Kenya University ethics review committee has approved the study and a NACOSTI permit has been issued. Taking part will be voluntary. Before signing the consent form (Appendix II), each respondent will be told what the study is about, what taking part involves and any possible risks. They may skip any question or pull out at any time without penalty. Names will not be written on questionnaires, and schools will be given codes. Respondents will be told clearly that the study is independent of the TSC and that nothing they say will be used for appraisal or discipline. Lesson observations will be agreed with the teacher beforehand, and interviews will only be recorded with permission. Electronic data will be kept on a password-protected computer and paper forms in a locked cabinet, and the raw data will be destroyed five years after the study. The researcher will respect local customs, for example by planning visits around prayer times and working through community leaders. All sources will be acknowledged, and the findings will be shared with the Sub-County Director of Education and the schools that took part.

REFERENCES

- African Population and Health Research Center. (2022). *Evaluating the quality of implementation of competency-based curriculum in Kenya: Evidence of effective lessons*. <https://aphrc.org/idea/evaluating-the-quality-of-implementation-competency-based-curriculum-in-kenya-evidence-of-effective-lessons/>
- Akala, B. M. M. (2021). Revisiting education reform in Kenya: A case of Competency Based Curriculum (CBC). *Social Sciences & Humanities Open*, 3(1), Article 100107. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ssaho.2021.100107>
- Awiti, C. M. (2023). *Factors affecting implementation of competency-based curriculum of education in primary schools in Nairobi City* [Master's project, University of Nairobi]. University of Nairobi Digital Repository. <https://erepository.uonbi.ac.ke/handle/11295/167233>
- Black, P., & Wiliam, D. (1998). Assessment and classroom learning. *Assessment in Education: Principles, Policy & Practice*, 5(1), 7–74. <https://doi.org/10.1080/0969595980050102>
- Braun, V., & Clarke, V. (2022). *Thematic analysis: A practical guide*. SAGE Publications.
- Cheruiyot, B. (2024). Challenges faced in the implementation of competency-based curriculum (CBC) in junior schools in Kenya. *East African Journal of Education Studies*, 7(3), 260–266. <https://doi.org/10.37284/eajes.7.3.2098>
- Creswell, J. W., & Creswell, J. D. (2023). *Research design: Qualitative, quantitative, and mixed methods approaches* (6th ed.). SAGE Publications.
- Darling-Hammond, L. (2017). Teacher education around the world: What can we learn from international practice? *European Journal of Teacher Education*, 40(3), 291–309. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02619768.2017.1315399>
- Darling-Hammond, L., Hyler, M. E., & Gardner, M. (2017). *Effective teacher professional development*. Learning Policy Institute. <https://doi.org/10.54300/122.311>
- Fullan, M. (2016). *The new meaning of educational change* (5th ed.). Teachers College Press.
- Guskey, T. R. (2002). Professional development and teacher change. *Teachers and Teaching*, 8(3), 381–391. <https://doi.org/10.1080/135406002100000512>

- Hall, G. E., & Hord, S. M. (2020). *Implementing change: Patterns, principles, and potholes* (5th ed.). Pearson.
- How TSC beat teachers crisis in Northeastern after mass exodus of non-locals. (2024, May 23). *The Star*. <https://www.the-star.co.ke/news/2024-05-23-how-tsc-beat-teachers-crisis-in-northeastern-after-mass-exodus-of-non-locals/>
- Hussein, A. M. (2023). The challenge face in the implementation of competency-based curriculum in northern Kenya. *African Journal of Education and Practice*, 9(3), 59–67.
- Jansen, J. D. (1998). Curriculum reform in South Africa: A critical analysis of outcomes-based education. *Cambridge Journal of Education*, 28(3), 321–331. <https://doi.org/10.1080/0305764980280305>
- Kailo, M., & Njagi, L. (2025). Investigating the influence of training resources and materials in in-service teacher training on the implementation of the competence-based curriculum in public primary schools in Kilifi County, Kenya. *East African Journal of Education Studies*, 8(3), 262–272. <https://doi.org/10.37284/eajes.8.3.3516>
- Karua, G. W., Manyasi, B., & Kara, A. (2025). Teacher preparedness to implement competency based curriculum in public primary schools in Kinangop Sub County, Kenya. *International Journal of Scientific Research and Management*, 13(2), 22–41. <https://doi.org/10.18535/ijssrm/v13i02.ee01>
- Kenya Institute of Curriculum Development. (2017). *Basic education curriculum framework*.
- Kenya National Bureau of Statistics. (2019). *2019 Kenya population and housing census: Volume I. Population by county and sub-county*.
- Keter, J., & Wabuke, J. (2025). Teacher preparedness and implementation of competency-based curriculum in public junior secondary schools in Bomet County, Kenya. *International Journal of Social Science and Economics Invention*, 11(7), 116–123.
- Kidega, C., Song, Z., Ugochinyere, I. C., James, O. A., & Ndikubwimana, F. (2024). Confronting challenges facing teachers in implementing competency-based curriculum in Uganda: A case of secondary schools in Gulu City. *East African Journal of Education Studies*, 7(2), 112–129. <https://doi.org/10.37284/eajes.7.2.1891>

- Komba, S. C., & Mwandangi, M. (2015). Reflections on the implementation of competence based curriculum in Tanzanian secondary schools. *Journal of Education and Learning*, 4(2), 73–80. <https://doi.org/10.5539/jel.v4n2p73>
- Kothari, C. R., & Garg, G. (2019). *Research methodology: Methods and techniques* (4th ed.). New Age International.
- Ministry of Education. (2019). *Sessional Paper No. 1 of 2019: A policy framework for reforming education and training for sustainable development in Kenya*. Government Printer.
- Mogere, V. B. (2022). *Determinants of competency-based curriculum implementation in public primary schools in Nairobi County* [Master's thesis, Kenyatta University]. Kenyatta University Institutional Repository. <https://ir-library.ku.ac.ke/items/145b97f8-a06b-4cad-ac5d-16892512ddfb>
- Momanyi, J. M., & Rop, P. K. (2019). Teacher preparedness for the implementation of competency based curriculum in Kenya: A survey of early grade primary school teachers in Bomet East Sub-County. *The Cradle of Knowledge: African Journal of Educational and Social Science Research*, 7(1), 10–15.
- Mugenda, O. M., & Mugenda, A. G. (2003). *Research methods: Quantitative and qualitative approaches*. ACTS Press.
- Murithi, J., & Yoo, J. E. (2021). Teachers' use of ICT in implementing the competency-based curriculum in Kenyan public primary schools. *Innovation and Education*, 3, Article 5. <https://doi.org/10.1186/s42862-021-00012-0>
- Mutua, M., & Waweru, S. (2023). Teachers' competence and its influence on effective implementation of competency based curriculum in public primary schools in Machakos County, Kenya. *International Journal of Social Science and Human Research*, 6(5), 3027–3038. <https://ijsshr.in/v6i5/67.php>
- Mwang'ombe, A. (2021). *Competency based curriculum (CBC) in Kenya: Teachers' understanding and skills, reality on the ground, successes, challenges and recommendations on the implementation of competency-based curriculum (CBC) in the Kenyan schools* [Unpublished manuscript]. ResearchGate. <https://www.researchgate.net/publication/356267149>
- Nsengimana, T., Mugabo, L. R., Hiroaki, O., & Nkundabakura, P. (2023). Science teachers' knowledge, understanding and perceptions of competence-based curriculum in three secondary schools in Rwanda. *European Journal of Educational Research*, 12(1), 317–331. <https://doi.org/10.12973/eu-jer.12.1.317>

- Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development. (2019). *TALIS 2018 results (Volume I): Teachers and school leaders as lifelong learners*. OECD Publishing. <https://doi.org/10.1787/1d0bc92a-en>
- Presidential Working Party on Education Reform. (2023). *Report of the Presidential Working Party on Education Reform: Transforming education, training and research for sustainable development in Kenya*. Government of Kenya. <https://www.education.go.ke/index.php/node/429>
- Saunders, M., Lewis, P., & Thornhill, A. (2019). *Research methods for business students* (8th ed.). Pearson.
- Shulman, L. S. (1986). Those who understand: Knowledge growth in teaching. *Educational Researcher*, 15(2), 4–14. <https://doi.org/10.3102/0013189X015002004>
- UNESCO & International Task Force on Teachers for Education 2030. (2024). *Global report on teachers: Addressing teacher shortages and transforming the profession*. UNESCO.
- Yamane, T. (1967). *Statistics: An introductory analysis* (2nd ed.). Harper & Row.

APPENDICES

Appendix I: Letter of Introduction

MOHAMED ABDI IBRAHIM

Mount Kenya University, School of Education

P.O. Box 342-01000, Thika

Dear Respondent,

RE: REQUEST TO PARTICIPATE IN A RESEARCH STUDY

I am a Master of Education student at Mount Kenya University, School of Education. As part of the requirements for the degree, I am carrying out a study titled “Influence of Teacher Preparedness on the Implementation of the Competency-Based Curriculum in Public Primary Schools in Habaswein Sub-County, Wajir County, Kenya”.

Your school is one of those selected for the study, and I kindly ask you to spare some time to fill in the questionnaire or take part in an interview. There are no right or wrong answers; I am only interested in your honest views and experience. Whatever you share will be kept confidential and used for academic purposes only. The study is not connected to the TSC in any way and will not be used for appraisal, and your name will not appear anywhere in the report.

Thank you for your time and cooperation.

Yours faithfully,

MOHAMED ABDI IBRAHIM

Reg. No. MED202432116

Appendix II: Informed Consent Form

I have been informed of the purpose of this study, what taking part involves, and my right to decline to answer any question or to withdraw at any time without any consequence. I understand that my responses will be kept confidential and used only for academic purposes, and that the study is not linked to TSC appraisal. I therefore voluntarily agree to take part in this study.

Signature of respondent: _____ Date: _____

Signature of researcher: _____ Date: _____

Appendix III: Questionnaire for Teachers

Instructions: Please tick (✓) the appropriate box or write your answer in the space provided. Do not write your name or the name of your school on this questionnaire.

Section A: Background Information

1. Gender: Male [] Female []
2. Age (years): Below 30 [] 30–39 [] 40–49 [] 50 and above []
3. Highest professional qualification: P1 Certificate [] Diploma [] Degree [] Postgraduate []
4. Teaching experience (years): Below 3 [] 3–5 [] 6–10 [] Above 10 []
5. Terms of service: TSC permanent [] TSC contract [] BOM []
6. Grades you currently teach: Grades 1–3 [] Grades 4–6 [] Both []
7. Location of your school: Habaswein town [] Rural settled [] Remote / pastoralist []
8. Approximate number of learners in your largest class: Below 40 [] 40–60 [] 61–80 [] Above 80 []

Section B: In-service Training on the CBC

9. Number of CBC in-service trainings you have attended: None [] 1 [] 2–3 [] 4 or more []
10. Total duration of all CBC trainings attended: Less than 3 days [] 3–5 days [] 6–10 days [] More than 10 days []

Key: SD = Strongly Disagree (1); D = Disagree (2); N = Neutral (3); A = Agree (4); SA = Strongly Agree (5)

No.	Statement	SD	D	N	A	SA
11	The CBC training I attended was long enough to cover what I needed.					
12	The content of the training was relevant to the learning areas I teach.					
13	The training prepared me to plan lessons under the CBC.					
14	The training prepared me to carry out competency-based assessment.					

No.	Statement	SD	D	N	A	SA
15	I received follow-up support (e.g. coaching, CSO visits) after the training.					
16	The training has improved the way I implement the CBC.					

Section C: Attitude towards the CBC

Key: SD = Strongly Disagree (1); D = Disagree (2); N = Neutral (3); A = Agree (4); SA = Strongly Agree (5)

No.	Statement	SD	D	N	A	SA
17	The CBC is more useful to learners than the 8-4-4 curriculum was.					
18	I feel confident teaching under the CBC.					
19	I am willing to try the new teaching methods the CBC requires.					
20	I enjoy teaching under the CBC.					
21	The workload that comes with the CBC is manageable.					
22	I would recommend that the CBC continues to be implemented.					

Section D: Pedagogical Skills

Key: SD = Strongly Disagree (1); D = Disagree (2); N = Neutral (3); A = Agree (4); SA = Strongly Agree (5)

No.	Statement	SD	D	N	A	SA
23	I prepare schemes of work based on the curriculum designs.					
24	I prepare lesson plans with specific learning outcomes and key inquiry questions.					
25	I use learner-centred methods such as group work, projects and discussion in most lessons.					
26	I deliberately develop core competencies in my lessons.					
27	I integrate values and pertinent and contemporary issues into my lessons.					
28	I improvise teaching and learning resources from the local environment.					
29	I use ICT devices in teaching where they are available.					

Section E: Competency-Based Assessment Skills

Key: SD = Strongly Disagree (1); D = Disagree (2); N = Neutral (3); A = Agree (4); SA = Strongly Agree (5)

No.	Statement	SD	D	N	A	SA
30	I use a variety of formative assessment methods (observation, oral questions, projects).					
31	I use rubrics to assess learners' competencies.					
32	I use observation checklists to record learners' progress.					
33	I keep up-to-date learner portfolios and assessment records.					
34	I give learners feedback after assessment.					
35	I share learners' progress with their parents.					

Section F: Implementation of the CBC

Key: SD = Strongly Disagree (1); D = Disagree (2); N = Neutral (3); A = Agree (4); SA = Strongly Agree (5)

No.	Statement	SD	D	N	A	SA
36	Learners actively take part in learning activities in my lessons.					
37	I cover the curriculum designs within the planned time.					
38	Learners complete projects as required by the curriculum designs.					
39	Learners take part in community service learning activities.					
40	Parents are involved in their children's learning activities.					
41	Most of my learners meet or exceed expectations in school-based assessment.					

Section G: Intervening Factors

Key: SD = Strongly Disagree (1); D = Disagree (2); N = Neutral (3); A = Agree (4); SA = Strongly Agree (5)

No.	Statement	SD	D	N	A	SA
42	My school has adequate CBC textbooks and teaching materials.					
43	Class sizes in my school allow me to use learner-centred methods.					

No.	Statement	SD	D	N	A	SA
44	Insecurity in the area affects teaching and learning in my school.					
45	The departure of teachers from my school has affected CBC implementation.					
46	Changes in government policy on the CBC/CBE have affected my work.					

Section H: General Comments

47. What would most help you to implement the CBC more effectively in your school?

.....

.....

.....

Thank you for your participation.

Appendix IV: Interview Guide for Head Teachers

Introduction: The researcher will introduce themselves, explain the purpose of the study, assure the head teacher of confidentiality, and seek consent to take notes and record the interview.

1. How long have you been head teacher in this school, and how many teachers do you have? How many are on contract or BOM terms?
2. What CBC training have your teachers received? How long was it, how relevant was it, and was there any follow-up?
3. How would you describe your teachers' attitude towards the CBC? Has it changed over time, and why?
4. How well do your teachers prepare schemes of work and lesson plans and use learner-centred methods?
5. How confident are your teachers in competency-based assessment, such as using rubrics, keeping portfolios and giving feedback?
6. What support do you, the curriculum support officers and the TSC give teachers in implementing the CBC?
7. How have resources, class size, insecurity, staff turnover and policy changes affected CBC implementation in this school?
8. In your view, how well is the CBC being implemented in this school? Can you give an example of good practice, and of where things fall short?

9. Do you see a difference in implementation between teachers who are better prepared and those who are less prepared?
10. What should the Ministry of Education, the TSC and KICD do to better prepare teachers in areas like Habaswein?

Appendix V: Classroom Observation Checklist

School code: _____ Grade: _____ Learning area: _____ Date: _____
 _____ Learners present: _____

Key: 0 = Not observed; 1 = Partly observed; 2 = Fully observed

No.	Aspect Observed	0	1	2	Remarks
	A. Pedagogical skills				
1	Lesson plan has specific learning outcomes and key inquiry questions				
2	Lesson introduction links to learners' prior knowledge and experience				
3	Learner-centred activities (group work, discussion, practical tasks) are used				
4	At least one core competency is deliberately developed				
5	Values and/or pertinent and contemporary issues are integrated				
6	Teaching and learning resources, including improvised ones, are used				
7	ICT is used where available				
	B. Competency-based assessment skills				
8	Formative assessment is carried out during the lesson				
9	A rubric or observation checklist is used to record learners' progress				
10	Teacher gives learners feedback on their work				
	C. Implementation				
11	Most learners actively take part in the lesson				
12	Lesson concludes with reflection or a link to real life				
13	Learners are given a project, community service or home-based activity involving parents				

Appendix VI: Document Analysis Guide

Document	Available (Yes/No)	Up to Date (Yes/No)	Remarks on Quality
Schemes of work based on curriculum designs			
Lesson plans			
Learner portfolios			
Assessment rubrics and observation checklists			
Formative / school-based assessment records			
Records of CBC training and professional development			
Inventory of CBC textbooks and teaching materials			
Records of instructional supervision by head teacher / CSO			
Teacher staffing records (including transfers since 2023)			

Appendix VII: Work Plan

Activity	Timeline
Development and approval of the research proposal	October – December 2026
Proposal defence and corrections	January 2027
Ethical clearance and NACOSTI research permit	February 2027
Pilot testing and refinement of instruments	February 2027
Field data collection	March – April 2027
Data analysis and interpretation	May 2027
Thesis writing and submission to supervisors	June – July 2027
Thesis defence, corrections and final submission	August 2027

Appendix VIII: Research Budget

Budget Item	Estimated Cost (KES)
Literature and reference materials	10,000
Printing and photocopying of instruments	12,000
Training and remuneration of 3 research assistants	36,000
Transport and security arrangements within Habaswein Sub-County	45,000
Accommodation and subsistence during fieldwork	30,000

Budget Item	Estimated Cost (KES)
Pilot study in Wajir South Sub-County	12,000
Communication and airtime	5,000
Data analysis software and services	15,000
Ethical review and NACOSTI permit fees	6,000
Thesis printing, binding and dissemination	12,000
Subtotal	183,000
Contingency (10%)	18,300
Total	201,300